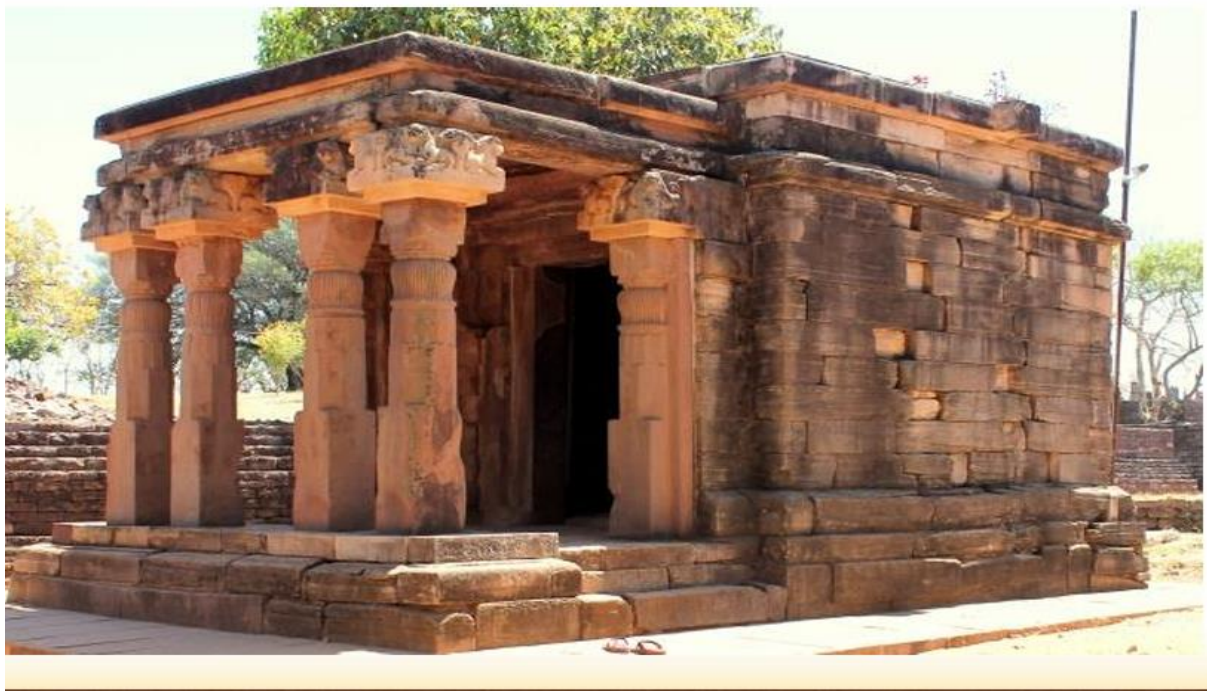


Indian Architecture & Sculpture

Sculpture: the action or art of processing (as by carving, modeling, or welding) plastic or hard materials into works of art.

North Indian Temple Architecture

- Evidence of the earliest known structural temples has been recovered through excavations from MAURYAN PERIOD
- A circular brick and timber shrine of the Mauryan period of 3rd century B.C., was excavated at Bairat District of Jaipur, Rajasthan.
- The first stage of temples had flat roof and shallow pillars but they began accumulating greater and richer features like shikhara and pradakshina path in the later stages.





2



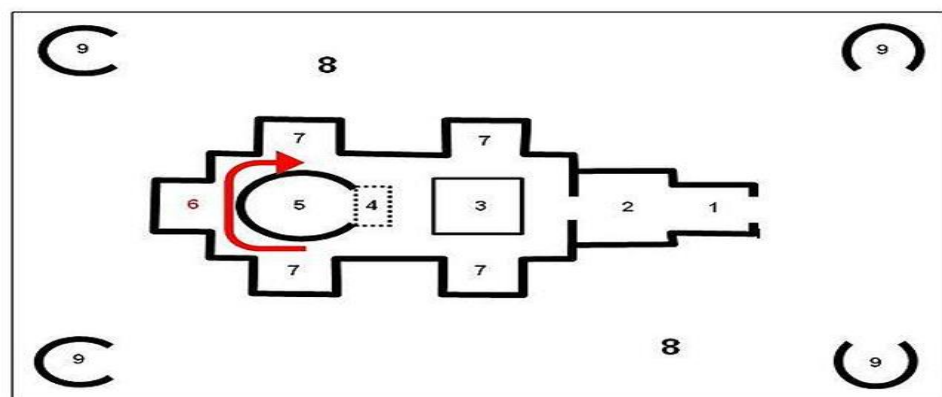
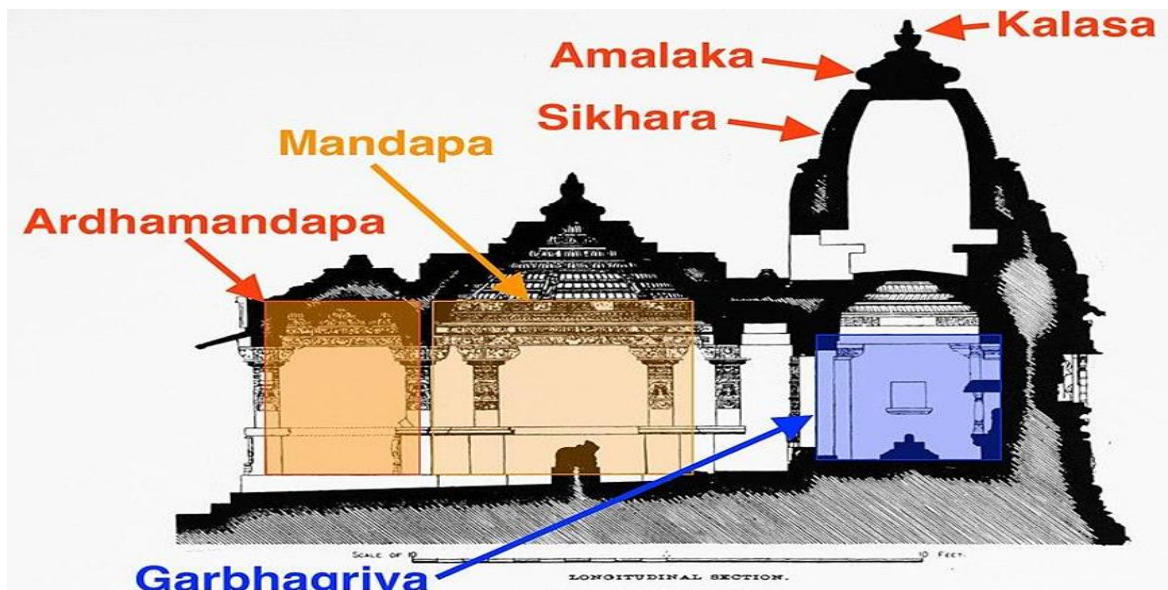
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4

Common features of temples

1. Garbhagriha – Also known as Sanctum Sanctorum, it is a small room which houses the principal deity of the temple.
2. Mandapa – Entrance to the temple. Could be a portico or a pillared hall.
3. Ardhamandapa – porch approaching the mandapa
4. Shikhara – It is a mountain like spire, usually on top of Garbhagriha.
5. Vahana – Mount or vehicle of the main deity placed before the garbhagriha.



1. Ardha mandapa
2. Mandapa
3. Maha mandapa
4. Antarala
5. Garba griha

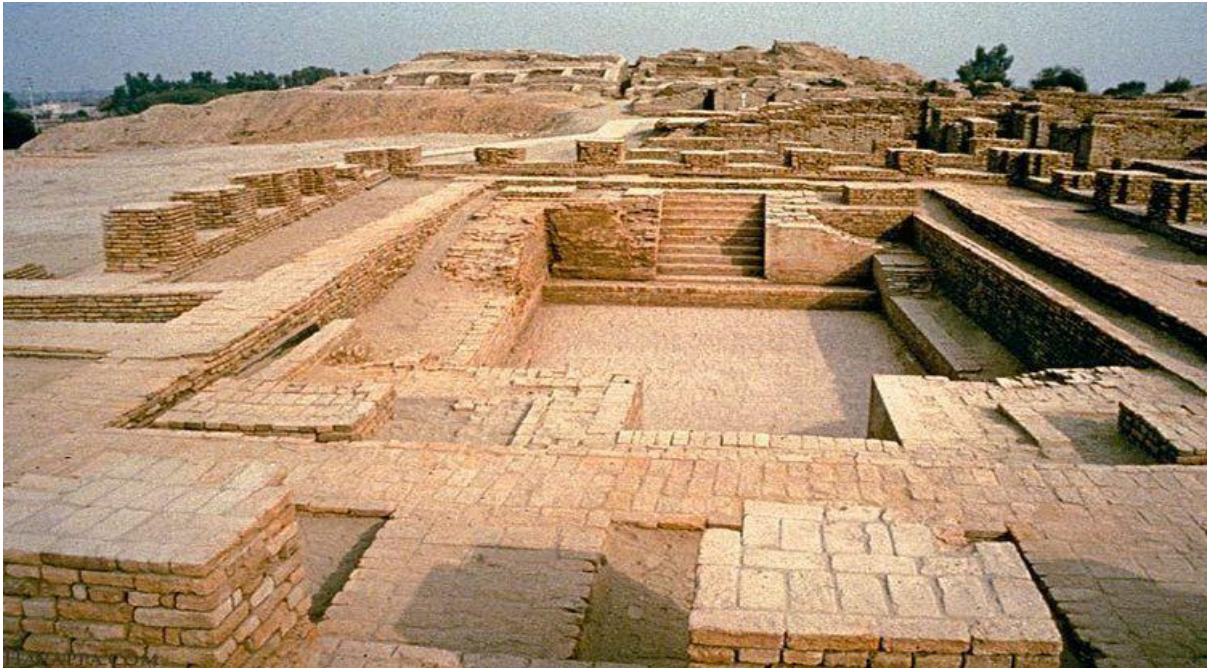
6. Pradakshina
7. Transepts
8. Jagati
9. Subsidiary shrines

The Harappan Civilization architecture

- showcased **indigenous** and **uninfluenced** architecture. Rather than focusing on **aesthetics**, their architectural designs **prioritized practical functionality**. Unlike grand palaces, monuments, or tombs, most structures were large-scale public buildings and spacious houses.
- During the Harappan civilization, the towns of **Harappa** and **Mohenjo-Daro** stood out for their remarkable town planning. Here are the essential features of their urban design:

- **Rectangular grid pattern:** The IVC cities were designed on a grid pattern, with streets running in a **north-south and east-west direction**, forming a well-organized layout.
- Streets and lanes were cutting across one another almost at **right angles**, thus dividing the city into several rectangular blocks.
- The main street was connected by narrow lanes. House doors opened in these lanes rather than the main streets.
- It shows the knowledge of **measurement** of the society of Harappan Civilization.
- **Planned streets:** The streets and alleyways of IVC cities were planned and constructed with precision. They were wide enough to allow the **movement of carts and pedestrians**, and some streets had covered drains running alongside them.
 - The main street was **ten meters wide**, dividing the town into rectangular and square blocks.
- **Fortification:** The cities were surrounded by **fortified walls made of mud bricks**, protecting robbers, cattle raiders and floods.
- **Division of cities:** The city was divided into two parts—An upraised citadel and the lower part of the city.
- **Upper part:** In the western part of these ancient cities, an elevated citadel was the foundation for constructing significant structures.
- These included granaries, **administrative buildings, pillared halls, and courtyards**.
- The citadel housed essential residential structures used by the general public or select residents.
- Notably, cities like **Harappa, Mohenjodaro, and Kalibangan** featured a citadel built atop a tall mud-brick podium.
- **Lower part:** Below the citadel in each city lay a lower town containing brick houses, which the common people inhabited.
- **Material used:** They used burnt bricks on a large scale in almost all kinds of constructions, and there was an absence of stone buildings during the Harappan Civilization culture.

- The houses were built of **mud bricks**, while the drainages were built with **burnt bricks**.
- **Standardized brick size:** The cities of Harappan Civilization were constructed using standardized bricks, with a uniform size of **1: 2: 4 ratios** in terms of thickness: width: length across all IVC structures. This standardization suggests a sophisticated level of planning and craftsmanship.
- There was equal **uniformity** in the **average size of bricks** for houses and city walls.
- **Residential areas:** The cities were divided into distinct residential areas.
 - Houses were made of **baked bricks**, often with **multiple stories**, indicating a well-developed urban society.
 - The houses were generally built around **courtyards**, and some had private wells and **properly ventilated bathrooms**.
 - No windows were facing the streets, and the bathrooms were tiled.
- **The Great Bath:** It is situated within a courtyard. Corridors can be found on all four sides, and stairs can be found on the northern and southern sides.
 - A flight of steps leads to the surface at either end. It was well-paved with several adjacent rooms. There were side rooms for changing clothes.
 - The bricks were water-tightly installed with gypsum mortar. The bath floor was made of burnt bricks.
 - It is associated with a ritual bath, which has been vital to any religious ceremony in India.
 - Water was drawn from a large well in an adjacent room, and an outlet from the corner of the bath led to a drain.
 - **Example:** Great Bath of Mohenjo-Daro.



- **Sophisticated drainage systems:** The drainage system of the Harappan Civilization was elaborate and well laid out.
 - Every house had drains connected to the street drains.
 - Drains were made of **mortar, lime and gypsum**.
 - These drains were covered with **manhole bricks or stone slabs** (which could be removed for cleaning) and were constructed at **regular intervals** by the side of the streets for cleaning.
 - This demonstrates that the people were well-versed in sanitation science.
- **Granaries and storage facilities:** The cities had **well-planned granaries and storage** facilities to store surplus agricultural produce. These structures featured thick walls to protect the stored food from pests and were often located near the citadel or the city centre.
 - **Granaries** was a brick structure built over **45 meters** in **north-south** and **east-west directions**. It was partly paved with baked bricks.
 - Each room has three sleeper walls with air space between them.
 - There was the presence of a small triangular opening that may serve as an air duct to allow the flow of fresh air beneath the hollow floors.

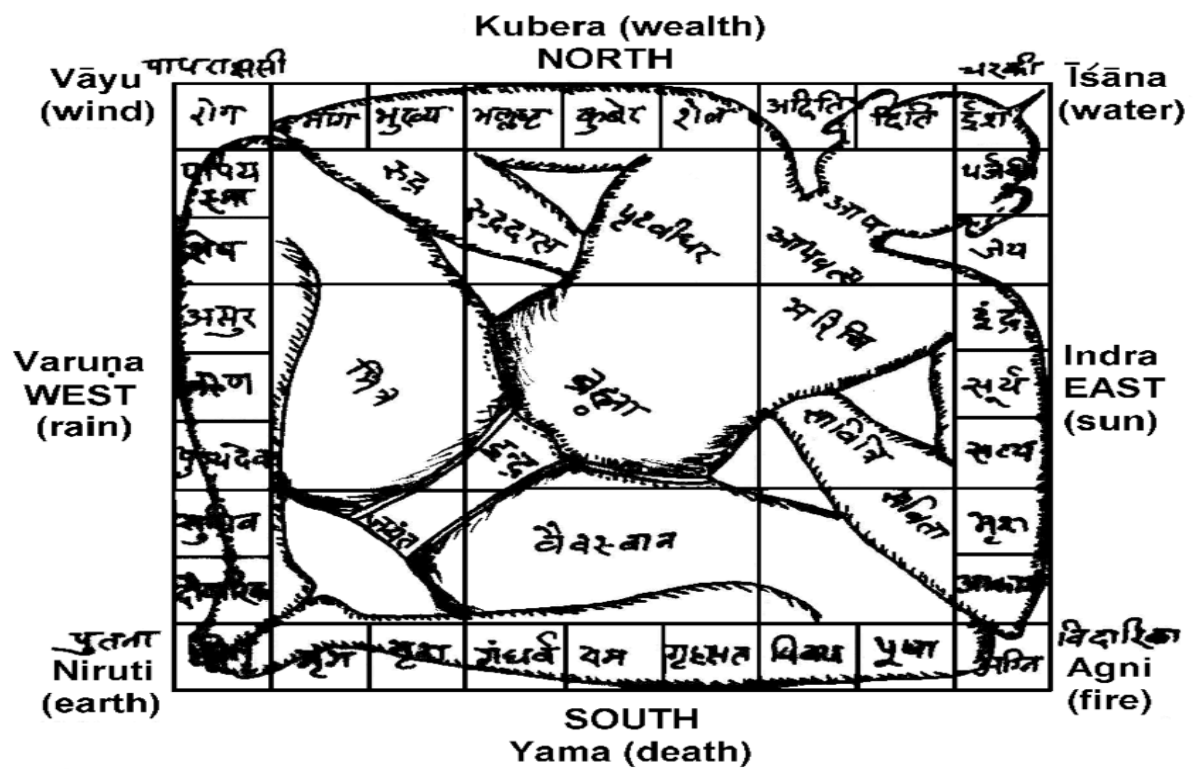
- Cities having granaries: **Mohenjo-Daro, Harappa, Kalibangan.**
- **Commercial areas:** Commercial areas were present within the cities, where artisans, craftsmen, and merchants conducted their trade. These areas had specialised workshops and shops, indicating a well-organized economic system.
 - Evidence of breadmaker shops has been found at **Chanhudaro and Lothal.**
- **Dockyard:** The dominant sight at Lothal is the massive dockyard, the greatest work of maritime architecture during the IVC. It was discovered on the banks of the **Sabarmati River.**
 - The structure's design demonstrates a thorough investigation of tides, hydraulics, and the effect of seawater on bricks.
 - **Lothal** is the only IVC city with a dockyard.
- **Town planning uniformity:** One notable aspect of IVC town planning was the **uniformity observed across multiple cities.**
 - The similarities in the layout, **construction techniques, and standardisation of bricks** indicate a centralised authority or a shared urban planning system.
- The town planning of the Harappan Civilization has had a profound influence on present-day urbanisation. Here are some key points:
- **Urban Planning:** The cities of the IVC, such as Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro, were well-planned and organized.
 - For instance, the city of **Chandigarh** in India, follows a similar grid system.
- **Zoning and Segregation:** The cities of the IVC were divided into a citadel or acropolis, likely inhabited by the ruling elite, and a lower town housing the general populace.
 - This principle of zoning and segregation is evident in today's urban landscapes, with dedicated sections for different socio-economic classes.
 - **Sanitation and Drainage:** The IVC had an impressive drainage system, with almost every house having its own bathroom and courtyard. Modern cities continue to strive for efficient sanitation and waste management systems.

- **Use of standardised construction material:** Using standardised, fired bricks in construction was a distinctive characteristic of the IVC.
 - This practice of using standardized construction materials is now a norm in modern construction.
- **Public spaces:** The Great Bath of Mohenjo-Daro, one of the first public water tanks in the ancient world, indicates the importance of public spaces in the IVC.
 - The concept of public spaces is integral to modern urban planning.
- Overall, the town planning of the Harappan Civilization reflects a highly organized and efficient urban society, characterized by a strong emphasis on hygiene, safety, and community welfare. The planning and structures of the Harappan Civilization have become a landmark for contemporary civilization.

Vastu shastra

- **What is Vastu Shastra?**
 - **Definition:** Vastu Shastra is an ancient Indian science of architecture and buildings that helps in creating a harmonious environment by aligning structures with natural forces.
 - **Purpose:** It aims to enhance health, wealth, prosperity, and happiness by optimizing the flow of energy in living and working spaces.
 - **Scope:** Covers various aspects of construction, including site selection, design, layout, measurements, ground preparation, space arrangement, and spatial geometry.
- **Origins and History**
 - **Ancient Roots:** Vastu Shastra dates back over 5000 years and is mentioned in ancient Indian texts like the Vedas and Puranas.
 - **Evolution:** Initially used in the construction of temples and palaces, it evolved to include homes and other buildings.

- **Influence:** Influenced by various Indian architectural traditions and practices.
- **Key Texts:** Manuscripts like “Manasara,” “Mayamatam,” and “Samarangana Sutra Dhara” provide detailed guidelines on Vastu principles.
- **Five Elements (Pancha Bhootas)**
 - **Earth (Prithvi):** Represents stability and patience. It is associated with the southwest direction.
 - **Water (Jal):** Symbolizes fluidity and adaptability. It is linked to the northeast direction.
 - **Fire (Agni):** Denotes energy and transformation. It is connected to the southeast direction.
 - **Air (Vayu):** Signifies movement and growth. It is associated with the northwest direction.
 - **Space (Aakash):** Represents expansion and openness. It is linked to the center of the structure.
- **Concept of Vastu Purusha Mandala**
 - **Definition:** A metaphysical diagram that represents the cosmic man (Vastu Purusha) and is used as a guide for layout and design.
 - **Significance:** Ensures that the structure is in harmony with cosmic energies.
 - **Application:** Used in site planning and building orientation.
 - **Structure:** Divided into 64 or 81 squares, each representing a specific deity and aspect of life.



Jyotisha

- Jyotish, often referred to as Vedic astrology, is a profound and ancient system of divination that has its roots deeply embedded in the rich tapestry of Indian culture and philosophy. With a history spanning thousands of years, Jyotish is much more than mere fortune-telling; it's a comprehensive science that explores the influence of celestial bodies on human life.
- Jyotish is as old as the Vedas themselves, and its origins can be traced back to the Vedic period.
- Vedic Roots: The Vedas, the oldest sacred texts of Hinduism, contain references to the study of celestial bodies and their significance. Jyotish finds its foundation in the Vedanga Jyotisha, one of the Vedangas or limbs of Vedic knowledge, dedicated to the science of astronomy and timekeeping.
- Yugas and Cosmic Cycles: Jyotish encompasses the concept of Yugas, where each age has a distinct astrological influence on human affairs.
- Ancient Scholars: The contributions of ancient scholars, such as Varahamihira, Aryabhata, and Parashara, played a pivotal role in shaping Jyotish into a refined system of astrological knowledge.
- Transmission through the Ages: The knowledge of Jyotish was passed down through the guru-shishya (teacher-student) tradition.
- Jyotish operates on a set of fundamental principles that help practitioners interpret the positions of celestial bodies.
- The Zodiac: Jyotish uses the sidereal zodiac, which aligns with the actual positions of stars and planets.
- Planetary Positions: The positions of planets in different signs and houses are central to Jyotish. The meanings and influences of the nine primary planets used in Jyotish, including the Sun, Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, Saturn, Rahu, and Ketu. Each planet carries unique symbolism and governs specific aspects of life.
- Nakshatras: The lunar mansions or Nakshatras provide deeper insights into a person's character and life events.
- Houses: Jyotish divides the birth chart into 12 houses, each representing specific areas of life. For example, the first house relates to the self, the second house to wealth

- The Janma Kundali, or birth chart, is the cornerstone of Jyotish.
- Casting a Birth Chart: the process of creating a Janma Kundali, which involves precise details such as the date, time, and place of birth. A well-prepared birth chart is a snapshot of the celestial positions at the time of an individual's birth.
- Components of a Birth Chart: A birth chart consists of planetary positions, Nakshatras, and houses. how these elements interact and influence a person's life. Planetary aspects, conjunctions, and the placement of the Ascendant (Lagna) are crucial factors in interpreting the chart.
- Transits: Planetary movements and their transits through different signs and houses play a crucial role in predicting future events. the significance of transits and how they are used to make short-term predictions.
- Ashtakavarga: This technique involves analyzing the strengths and weaknesses of different planets in the birth chart.
- Divisional Charts: Jyotish uses various divisional charts, or vargas, to explore specific areas of a person's life in more detail. the purpose and significance of divisional charts, such as the Navamsa chart for marriage and the Dashamsha chart for career.
- Jyotish not only predicts future events but also offers remedies to mitigate negative influences and enhance positive ones.
- Gemstone Therapy: Wearing specific gemstones associated with favorable planets is a common remedy. the significance of gemstones and how they are chosen based on the individual's birth chart. Gemstone recommendations take into account the planetary rulership and gemstone properties.
- Mantras and Rituals: Chanting mantras and performing rituals can help balance planetary energies and neutralize negative karma. the role of mantras and rituals in Jyotish remedies, including specific mantras for different planets and the importance of regular practice.
- Charity and Acts of Kindness: Engaging in acts of charity and kindness is believed to offset negative karma and enhance positive planetary influences. We'll delve into the importance of charity in Jyotish remedies and how it aligns with the principle of dharma.

VEDAS

- The word 'Veda' generally refers to 'Mantras' and 'Brahmanas'. Mantras are hymns in praise of gods who are invoked in a ritual and Brahmanas are those portions which give various instructions on the performance of rituals.
- Based on this, Veda is said to be of two kinds, Mantras and Brahmanas.
- An anthology of mantras is known as 'Samhitas' and the Brahmana portions are an elaboration and are treated as the commentary to the Samhita portions.
- The Brahmana portions are further divided into three, the Brahmanas, the Aranyakas and the Upanisads.
- The Brahmana portions primarily teach the nature of ritual (yaga) and thus the word Brahmana also means 'yajna' (ritual).
- The Aranyakas are so named because it deals with meditation which are generally taken up while living in forest (aranya).
- The Upanisads reveal the Absolute Truth, which provides the means to liberation and is popularly known as the 'Vedanta'. Primarily the source with the four portions, namely, Samhita, Brahmana, Aranyaka and the Upanisad is known as the Veda. But popularly the ritualistic and meditative portions (or at times only the ritualistic portions) came to be known as Veda and the philosophical discovery in the Upanisads got a distinct identity. Therefore, the Veda and Upanisads. (But upanisads are also part of the Vedas.)

For a Vedic ritual to take place, it requires four Rtviks (roughly translated as Priests).

- They are: i) Hota – one who invokes the deity of a particular ritual by employing the invocatory hymns as found in the Rig-Samhitas and the collections of such hymns is referred to as Rig Veda.
- ii) Adhvaryu – one who performs the rituals as enjoined and the relevant mantras are in the Yajur-Samhita and the collection of this is known as Yajurveda

- iii) Udgatha – one who sings in high intonation and maintains the rhythm of chanting as given in Samaveda
- iv) Brahma – one who takes care of the entire proceedings of the ritual and suggests compensatory acts in case of omissions and commissions

Rig Veda

The word 'Rig' means praise or eulogy. The collection of Rig is known as Rig Veda. It is set in metrical form. The Rig is considered as the oldest record of revelations and the language of the Rig is considered as the most ancient.

There are five branches of Rig-Samhita and they are:

1. Shakala
2. Vaskala
3. Ashvalayana
4. Samkhya
5. Mandakayana

Rig-Samhita contains Suktas and Mandalas. Sukta means that which has been received from a reliable source and it is of four types:

- a. Richi Sukta
- b. Devata Sukta
- c. Chanda Sukta
- d. Artha Sukta

Yajurveda

- It is widely popular with varied descriptions of the yajna or rituals and is found in prose form. There are two divisions of Yajur, namely Krishna Yajurveda and Shukla Yajurveda. The Krishna Yajur is a combination of mantras and brahmanas, whereas, the Shukla Yajur is predominantly mantra portions.
- The Shukla Yajur is further divided into Madhyandina branch and Kanva branch. There is only a slight difference in the rendering of the contents of these two branches of Shukla Yajurveda. The famous available

brahmana of the Krishna Yajurveda is the Taittiriya Brahmana and that of Shukla Yajur is Shatapatha Brahmana. The main Aranyaka portions of the Yajurveda are Taittiriya Aranyaka and Brihadaranyaka (also contains upanisadic portions). The widely read Upanisads of the Krishna Yajurveda are Kathopanishad and Taittiriyaopanishad. The upanisads of the Shukla Yajurveda are Brihadaranayka and the Ishopanishad.

Samaveda

- The Samaveda is the **Rig Veda set in musical form**. The Samaveda consists of **two predominant parts**, viz., the **Archika part and the Ganam part**. The Archika part is that which consists of **meanings of the words**. It is further divided into **Purva Archika and Uttara Archika**. The Purva Archika consists of **six chapters** and is divided into **four parts** as:
 - 1. Agneya parva (consists of mantras related to Agni)
 - 2. Aindra parva (consists of mantras related to Indra)
 - 3. Pavamana parva (with mantras related to Soma)
 - 4. Aranyakas (meditations)

Atharvaveda

- The Atharvaveda consists of nine branches and only two such branches available, namely, the Shaunaka branch and the Pippalada branch. There are three Samhitas of the Atharva, namely, Aashi, Acharya and Vidhiprayoga Samhitas. The only available Brahmana of the Atharvaveda is the Gopatha Brahmanam. It consists of two parts, Purvagopatha and Uttaragopatha.

UPANISADS

- The Upanisads are the prime source of many philosophical conclusions. The word Upanisad can be split as upa+ni+sat; to mean ‘upa’ – approaching a teacher; ‘ni’ – for knowledge; ‘sat’ – to attain liberation
- Vedas or the source of knowledge, is also referred to as the Sruti. The content of the Vedas that has come down to us for centuries is said to have been heard by the sages in deep meditation. The word ‘Veda’

generally refers to 'Mantras' and 'Brahmanas'. Mantras are hymns in praise of gods who are invoked in a ritual and Brahmanas are those portions which give various instructions on the performance of rituals. The Aranyakas deals with meditation which is generally taken up while living in forest (aranya). The Upanisads reveal the Absolute Truth, which provides the means to liberation and is popularly known as the 'Vedanta.' The Vedic Literature is vast with several branches and sections. The Vedic concepts and doctrines have highly influenced the religious and philosophical thinking of India.

Vedangas

- Vedanga literally means "**limbs of the Vedas**," and refers to the six disciplines connected with studying the Vedas, the ancient Indian spiritual writings.
- The study, preservation, and interpretation of the Vedas can all be aided by these six "limbs" working together.
- They were created in ancient India to offer students of the Vedas a comprehensive and complete grasp of the literature.

The six Vedangas are as follows

- Shiksha or phonetics or pronunciation
- Kalpa or ritual
- Vyakarana or grammar
- Nirukta or etymology
- Chandas or metre
- Jyotisha or astronomy

Shiksha

- Shiksha literally means 'teaching in reciting,' i.e., precise pronunciation of the Samhita texts.
- Thus, the Shiksha-Sutras are phonetic treatises. They are linked to the Samhita and so virtually as old as the Kalpa-Sutras.
- Shiksha establishes the norms of phonetics — the sounds of syllables and pronunciation.
- The Shiksha's job is therefore to fix the parameters of Vedic words. Phonetics is especially significant in the case of the Vedic

language, because changes in sound lead to changes in consequences and effects.

- Shiksha, or Vedic Phonetics, has therefore been regarded as the most significant of the six Angas (organs) of the Veda Purusha.

Kalpa

- The second Vedanga is Kalpa (ritual), which is known as the Veda Purusha's arms.
- It is designed specifically for the right use of Vedic scriptures.
- The earliest Kalpa Sutras are those whose contents are intimately related to the Brahmanas and Aranyakas.
- The ritual (Kalpa), the main topic of the Brahmanas, was the first subject to systematic treatment in the manuals known as the Kalpa Sutras.
- They include the regulations in Sutra form, relating to sacrifices, with the elimination of any items not directly related to the ceremony.
- They are more practical than the Brahmanas, who are mostly concerned with spiritual, historical, mythical, etymological, and theological debates.

Vyakarana

- Vyakarana, or grammar, is the third Vedanga, and it is required for interpreting the Veda.
- ✕ • Some grammatical words may be found in the Aranyakas.
- The Ashtadhyayi of Panini, which dates to a later age, is the only representative of this Vedanga. It is, undoubtedly, the most well-known grammar textbook.
- Grammar is primarily concerned with word-formation. It examines the root (Prakriti) and suffix (Pratyaya) of a word to determine its meaning.
- Vyakarana by Panini is written in the form of sutras or aphorisms..

Nirukta

- Nirukta Vedanga is known as the Veda Purusha's ears.
- 'Nirukta' means 'etymology,' and it explains why a specific term has been employed, i.e., the meaning of use.

- The **Nirukta** of Yaska is the sole work that has survived as an example of this Vedanga 'etymology.'
- X • The first segment is made up of three lists that group Vedic terms together according to certain **fundamental principles**.
- X • The most fascinating element of the **Nirukta** is the discussion that spans the whole first book and a portion of the second, as well as the seventh book, which served as an excellent introduction to the study of the Veda.

Chandas

- **Chandas Vedanga** is considered as the **Veda Purusha's feet**. The Vedas' body is supported by the Chandas, which are shaped like feet.
- **Each Vedic Mantra** has its own Chandas, as well as a governing Devata. The term Chandas, according to Nirukta, is derived from the root Chad (to cover).
- It is metris known as **Chandas** because it encompasses the essence of the Mantra.
- **The Chandas** are intended to ensure correct reading and recitation of Vedic literature. Vedanga's metrics literature is similarly limited.

Jyotisha

- The last **Vedanga Jyotisha** is known as the **Veda Purusha's eye** — the organ of seeing.
- The goal of Jyotisha Vedanga is not to educate astronomy, but to impart knowledge of the celestial bodies essential for determining the days and hours of Vedic sacrifices.
- Study of the movement of the **Sun, the Moon, the Star**, and planets helped determine the time of the day and night, the day of the week and fortnight, the period of the seasons, the month and the year, besides the influence of each heavenly object on the events of the world and the lives of the people.

UNIVERSAL HUMAN VALUES

- Human values can be understood as the values that have been conceived and preferred by the people in a society that has inspired their actual conduct and behavior and prepared them to attain the best in their lives.

Human values involve the process of selection, preference and acceptance of certain values for life.

- Human values, as discussed by Nicolai Hartmann (1967), can be understood as the conditions which determine and shape human culture and also is conditioned by it in order to gain universal acceptance.
- It is **important** to state that **human values have evolved over a very long period.** Humans have **created and recreated** them **based on their social and cultural surroundings such as:**
 - **Influences from Culture and Society:** Culture has a **big impact on how people value things.** The **socialization processes** that take place in **families, communities, educational institutions, and larger cultural contexts frequently result in the transmission of values.** Specific values within a culture can arise and are reinforced through cultural norms, traditions, and practices.
 - **Family and Upbringing:** **The formation of human values is significantly influenced by family dynamics and upbringing.** An individual's value system is greatly influenced by the values they are taught by their parents or other key caregivers, as well as by the **family's cultural, religious, or ideological backgrounds.**
 - **Formal Institutions and Education:** Education, both **formal and informal,** is a key factor in determining values. Values can be taught at educational institutions through their **curricula, instructional strategies, and extracurricular activities.** The development of people's value systems can be influenced by the values that are promoted in educational systems and institutions.
 - **Personal Experiences and Interactions:** Human values can be shaped and altered through personal experiences, **such as social interactions and exposure to various viewpoints.** Events can have a positive or negative impact on a person's values by causing them to reflect and reevaluate their views and priorities. Examples of such events include personal successes, hardships, or experiencing injustice.
 - **Media and Popular Culture:** **By promoting popular ideas, customs, and lifestyles, media, including television, films, books, and social media, can shape values.** A person's exposure to new ideas, challenges to their held beliefs, or reinforcement of society values can all be influenced by the media.

- **Religion and Spirituality:** For many people, religion and spiritual beliefs play a crucial role in forming the core of their human values. A framework for moral principles, ethical precepts and value systems that affect believers' behaviours and decision-making is frequently provided by religious teachings and scriptures.
- **SUPREME GOALS (PURUSHARTHAS)**
- The dominant interest of the Indian thought is in the highest value of human life. There are four values, which give meaning to human life. They are called **Purusharthas: 1) Dharma 2) Artha 3) Kama 4) Moksha.**

Dharma

- The term 'dharma' gathered more and more meaning down the ages and it became a term of complex and varied meanings. For dharma the dictionary suggests the terms like virtue, duty, right, morality, justice, good, characteristics, tradition, ordinance and law etc. But dharma is essentially a human value operating in the universe of human ideals.
- Dharma is usually distinguished into sadharana dharma and varnashrama dharma. sadharana dharma refers to the duties of the universal scope and validity. There are ten cardinal virtues known as sadharana dharma according to Manu; endurance, Patience, self-control, integrity, purity, restraint of senses, wisdom, learning, truth and absence of anger or non-violence. The varnashrama dharma refers to the duties of persons according to the castes and the stages of life. Thus 'dharma' is considered to be a means for attaining personal integration in the spiritual level or liberation.

Artha (Wealth)

- The term 'artha' generally indicates the attainment of riches and worldly prosperity, advantage, profit and wealth. It means the whole range of tangible objects that can be possessed, enjoyed or lost and which we require in daily life for the upkeep of a household, raising of a family and discharge of religious duties.
- The materialistic aspects of life have great significance, because the absence of economic well-being of man is a great hindrance to the pursuit of personality integration and good life. Absence of economic wellbeing may also lead a man to adopt or to do immoral deeds to satisfy himself

Kama (Satisfaction of Desires)

- Kama is a comprehensive term, which includes all desires
- There is always a clear emphasis on the enjoyment of secular pleasures along with the emphasis on the realization of spiritual values

Moksha (Liberation)

- Moksha is also known as by other names such as mukti, apavarya, kaivalya and nirvana.
- As an ideal, moksha is pursued by an individual as a personal value. It is a spiritual perfection understood by the intellect, loved by the will and actualized in the daily life. It is understood as Jivanmukti in Advaita Vedanta. The man who has attained liberation in this life is called Jivanmukta. Different schools propose different ways to attain Moksha
- To attain Moksha, one has to be freed from the bondage to one's own actions.

Jainism

Causes for the Origin of Jainism

- Jainism became prevalent in the 6th century B.C. when Lord Mahavira propagated the religion.
- There were 24 teachers, referred to as jinas or the Tirthankaras, the last of whom was Lord Mahavira
- The Varna system partitioned the people into 4 classes based on their birth, where the two upper classes enjoyed various privileges and the lower castes led a miserable life.

Vardhamana Mahavira

- Vardhamana Mahavira, Jainism's 24th and last Tirthankara, was born in Kundagrama near Vaishali in 540 B.C.
- At the age of 30 years, he renounced his home and became an ascetic.
- He practiced austerity for 12 years and acquired the highest spiritual knowledge termed Kaivalya (conquered sorrow and happiness) at 42.

- He delivered his first sermon at Pava.
- From this time until his death, he taught the philosophy of Jainism for 30 years.
- He died at 72 at Pavapuri in Bihar in 468 B.C.

Jainism originated in ancient India and has had a significant impact on the religious and cultural landscape of the region. While Jainism is considered a minority religion today, it has had periods of significant influence and has spread to various parts of India and beyond.

In Jainism, the idea of God is quite different from the concept found in many other religions. Jainism is an ancient Indian religion emphasising non-violence, self-control, and spiritual liberation. It strongly emphasises individual responsibility and the pursuit of enlightenment, known as moksha or nirvana. Jainism does not believe in a supreme creator or ruler of the universe. Instead, it teaches that every living being has the potential to achieve liberation and become divine through self-realization and the purification of the soul. The Jains believe that each soul, known as a jiva.

The Jain order has been divided into two important sects or schools: Digambara and Svetambara.

Digambara means sky clad. Digambaras stressed on nudism as the absolute prerequisite to accomplishing salvation.

Shvetambara means white-clad. Shvetambaras defend that complete nudism is not required for attaining salvation.

Triratna

To achieve the soul's liberation, the three jewels of Jaina ethics must be followed.

- **Samyag Darshana (Right faith)**: This means to see (hear, feel, etc.) things correctly, avoiding preconceived notions and superstitions that may get in the way of viewing clearly.
- **Samyag Jnana (Right knowledge)**: This means having precise and adequate knowledge of the real universe. This necessitates a real knowledge of the five substances and nine truths of the universe with the proper mental attitude.
- **Samyag Charitra (Right conduct)**: This means avoiding harm to living beings and liberating oneself from impure thoughts and attitudes

Pancha Mahavrata

In order to accomplish Triratna, one has to follow the Pancha Mahavrata or the five great vows

Ahimsa (Non-violence)

- Non-violence is the supreme religion (Ahimsa parmo dharma).
- Non-violence is the fundamental aspect of Jainism.
- No living being has the right to hurt, harm or kill another living being, including animals, plants and insects.
- Jainism strictly preaches vegetarianism, forbidding harming animals with two or more senses.
- In Jainism, non-violence is seen in one's action, speech, and thought.

Satya (Truth-Do not lie)

- In Jainism, one should always speak up for the truth; there is no place for lies.
- People who have won greed, fear, envy, anger and ego can only speak the truth.

Asteya (non-stealing)

- Jainism is against robbing or grabbing others' property by unethical means.
- Even when you are getting any help or alms, you should never take more than what is needed.

Brahmacharya (observe continence)

- Chastity refers to refraining completely from sensual pleasures.
- monks are needed to follow this vow completely
- Monks sacrifice everything to attain brahmacharya

Aparigraha (non-attachment)

- A person seeking spiritual liberation must pull out from all possessions to objects that may please the five senses.

- Mahavira said, "Needs and desires have no end, and the sky's the limit for them".
- The wealth that a common man wishes to achieve creates an attachment that will continuously cause greed, envy, selfishness, ego, enmity, cruelty, etc.

Decline of Jainism

- **Competition with Buddhism and Hinduism:** Jainism faced competition from these two major religions.
- **Lack of Popular Preachers:** After Mahavira, there were few charismatic Jain religious leaders.
- **Loss of Royal Patronage:** The decline in support from royalty impacted the popularity of Jainism.

Jain Architecture

Gumphas / Layana (Caves)

- Ellora Caves- Maharashtra
- Mangi Tungi Cave- Maharashtra
- Gajpantha Cave- Maharashtra
- Udayagiri-Khandagiri Caves- Odisha
- Hathi-gumpha Cave- Odisha
- Sittanavasal Cave- Tamil Nadu

Statues

- Gomateshwara/Bahubali Statue in Shravanabelagola, Karnataka
- Statue of Ahimsa(Rishabhnaath) in Mangi-Tungi hills, Maharashtra

Buddhism

Buddhism is one of the oldest religions in the world, Buddhism has its roots in India and **dates back 2,500 years**. Buddhists hold that **enlightenment**, or nirvana, can be **attained by meditation, hard work both spiritual and physical and good conduct**

History & Origin of Buddhism

- Buddhism arose **2,600 years ago in India** as a way of living helpful in enhancing one's life.
- In the countries of **South and Southeast Asia**, it is one of the most **important religions**.
- Buddha is also called **Sakyamuni or Tathagata**.
- Buddhism was founded on the teachings and life experiences of **Siddhartha Gautam, who was born in 563 BCE**.
- He was born into the **royal dynasty of the Sakya clan**, which ruled from Kapilvastu on the **Indo-Nepal border in Lumbini**.
- **Gautama left home at the age of 29, opting for asceticism, or extreme self-discipline, over a life of prosperity**.
- After **49 days of meditation, Gautama gained Bodhi (enlightenment)** under a **pipal tree in Bodhgaya, a hamlet in Bihar**.
- Buddha presented his **first sermon in the village of Sarnath, Uttar Pradesh**, near the city of **Benares**. **Dharma-Chakra-Pravartana** is the name given to this phenomenon (turning of the wheel of law).
- In **483 BCE, he died at the age of 80 in Kushinagar, a town in Uttar Pradesh**.

Rise of Buddhism

- The 6th century B.C. was a perfect time for Buddhism to spread.
- People were fed up with superstitions, complicated rituals and rites, and blind beliefs during the time.
- Buddhism lacked the strictness of Jainism and the complexity of Vedic ceremonies.
- The Buddha's personality endeared him and his faith to the public. The Buddha was kind and selfless.
- Buddhism did not believe in castes. It was anti-caste and treated people from all castes equally.
- Universities at Nalanda, Taxila, Puspagiri, and Vikramsila played a significant role in the spread of Buddhism.

- Students studying in these institutes from all over India and from other countries were drawn to Buddhism and embraced it.

Eight-Fold Paths of Buddhism

1	Right Vision (Samma-Ditthi)	It is about comprehending the nature of reality and the path of transformation
2	Right Thought or Attitude (Samma-Sankappa)	It denotes emotional intelligence as well as behaving from a place of love and compassion.
3	Right or Whole Speech (Samma-Vacca)	It refers to communications that are truthful, straightforward, uplifting, and non-harmful.
4	Right or Integral Action (Samma-Kammanta)	It denotes a moral foundation for life-based on principles of non-exploitation of oneself and others.
5	Right or Proper Livelihood (Samma-Ajiva)	It emphasises livelihood based on correct action and non-exploitation ethical standards. This is seen to be the foundation of a perfect society.
6	Right Effort or Energy (Samma-Vayama)	it refers to intentionally directing our life energy toward the transformative path of creative and healing action that promotes wholeness and so moves us closer to conscious evolution.
7	Right Mindfulness (Samma-Sati) or Thorough Awareness (Samma-Sati)	It entails understanding oneself and observing one's own behaviour.
8	Right Concentration (Samma-Samadhi) or Meditation (Samma-Samadhi)	samadhi literally means " fixed, absorbed in. " It entails immersing one's entire being in several levels or modes of consciousness and awareness.

Mahayana

- It believed in the **divinity of the Buddha.**
- Encouraged **idol worship** within Buddhism.
- Followers of the Mahayana sect can be found **in China, (South) Korea, Japan, and Tibet.**
- Scriptures were **written in Sanskrit.**

Hinayana

- It did not believe in the divinity of the Buddha, rather it emphasised individual salvation through self-discipline and meditation.
- Followed by Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, and Laos.
- Scriptures were written in Pali

Decline of Buddhism

- The Buddha's teachings were conveniently forgotten, and the Buddhist monks and their preachings began to suffer as a result. Buddhism has had its share of sects over the years. Buddhism's originality was lost as a result of its fragmentation into several breakaway groups such as Hinayana, Mahayana, Vajrayana, Tantrayana, and Sahajayana.